Owen Wallace

Infrastructure & Operations Engineer

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SUMMARY

Infrastructure and operations engineer who deploys, runs, and keeps production systems healthy. Comfortable taking a business from no technical foundation to a working stack: containerized services, reverse proxy and HTTPS, monitoring and alerting, networking, and secure remote access on self-managed Linux servers. Builds and ships custom software by directing AI-assisted development, then owns the deployment and operations end to end. Strong at troubleshooting, keeping things running, and turning messy problems into systems that work.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Docker Compose, multi-container service stacks

Monitoring & Observability: Grafana, Prometheus, node-exporter, automated health checks

Networking & Access: Caddy (reverse proxy, automatic HTTPS/TLS), Tailscale, SSH, DNS, Samba

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu), systemd service management, command line, cron

Software Delivery: AI-assisted development: directing AI tooling to build, deploy, and maintain custom applications

AI / ML Infrastructure: Ollama (local model serving), NVIDIA GPU configuration

EXPERIENCE

Infrastructure & Operations Engineer (Independent Contractor)

HVAC / Home Services Company - Portland, TN March 2023 - May 2026

- Directed AI-assisted development to design, build, and deploy **TradeFlow**, a custom business platform self-hosted on Linux infrastructure I administered. Owned requirements, architecture decisions, deployment, and ongoing operations, replacing manual processes with the client's first centralized operations software.
- Containerized and operated production services with Docker, managing multi-container stacks (application, database, cache, and ML services) and keeping them healthy in a live environment.
- Configured Caddy as a reverse proxy with automatic HTTPS/TLS across multiple production domains and subdomains.
- Stood up an observability stack with Grafana, Prometheus, and node-exporter, plus automated health monitoring, to track uptime and catch issues before they became outages.
- Integrated local AI model serving (Ollama) into internal business software, running models on self-managed GPU hardware instead of paid third-party APIs.
- Administered the full Linux server: networking via Tailscale, SSH access, Samba file shares, scheduled jobs, and automated security updates.
- Rebuilt the client's financial picture from zero. Reconstructed 6 months of invoices and bank statements into a working P&L, then produced revenue projections, pricing recommendations, and renegotiated supplier costs.

SELF-HOSTED INFRASTRUCTURE (PORTFOLIO)

A personal homelab run as a real production environment: used daily, monitored continuously, and exposed securely to the public internet. Demonstrates the same skills operations and infrastructure roles hire for, on systems I own and operate end to end.

- **Reverse proxy & TLS:** Caddy fronting 9 live subdomains with automatic certificate management.
- **Containerized services:** Jellyfin (media), Immich (photos, with Postgres + Redis + ML service), Kavita (library), Grafana, Prometheus, and Ollama, all orchestrated with Docker.
- **Monitoring:** Grafana dashboards backed by Prometheus and node-exporter for real-time metrics and alerting.
- **Networking & security:** Tailscale mesh VPN, SSH hardening, internal-only service binding, and automated unattended upgrades.
- **Custom apps:** a custom business platform (TradeFlow) and a self-hosted wiki, both built with AI-assisted development and maintained on the same stack.

EDUCATION & CONTINUED LEARNING

- Self-directed study in systems administration, DevOps practices, and software engineering, applied directly to production workloads.